TurboEA

The digital twin of your IT landscape

Open Source • Self-Hosted • Privacy-First

13	29	10+	100%
Card Types	Relation Types	Report Types	Self-Hosted

Executive Decision Brief | February 2026 | Vincent Verdet – Enterprise Architecture Leader – Zürich, Switzerland

The Problem

Enterprise Architecture tools carry enterprise price tags

$ EAM Platforms

LeanIX, Ardoq, Mega

$100K+

/year for mid-size org

$ BPM Suites

ARIS, Signavio, iGrafx

$50K+

/year for mid-size org

$ Combined Need

EA + BPM + Diagrams

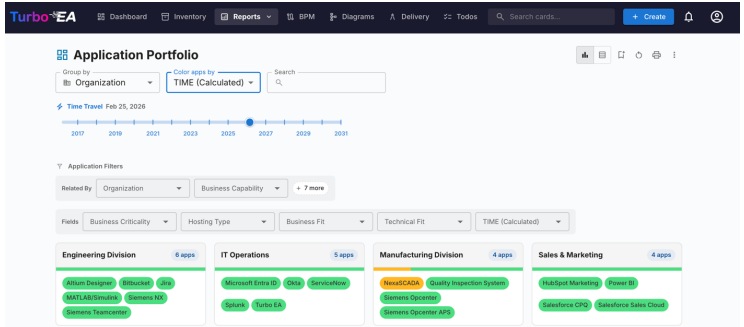
$150K+

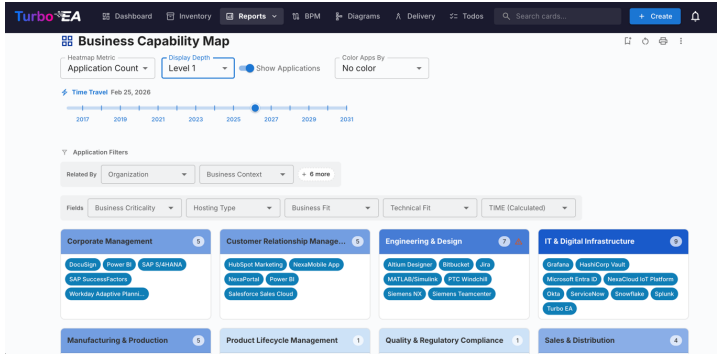
/year total commitment

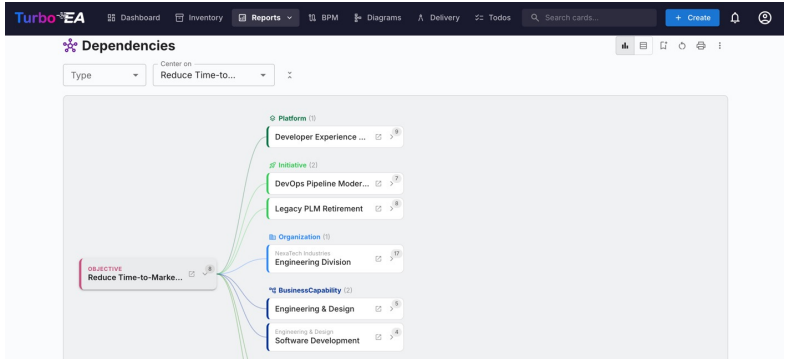
Most mid-size companies don't need a Gartner Magic Quadrant leader. They need something practical, fast to deploy, and honest about what it does. Turbo EA is free and open source under the MIT License.

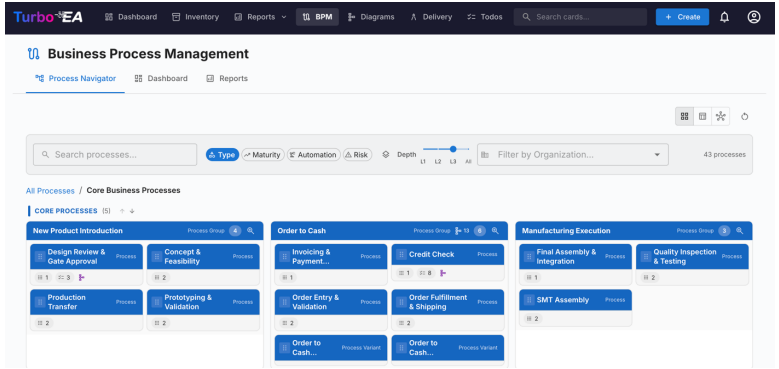
Turbo EA at a Glance

EA inventory, 10+ reports, BPMN 2.0, diagrams, delivery tracking, and web portals in one platform









What You Get

Configurable Metamodel

13 card types, 29 relation types, custom fields — all admin-configurable, not code

10+ Interactive Reports

Portfolio, capability heatmap, lifecycle, dependencies, cost treemap, matrix, data quality, EOL

BPMN 2.0 Editor

Native process modeler — the only open-source EA platform with built-in BPMN 2.0

Dependency & Impact Analysis

Interactive network graphs with BFS depth limiting, trace impact paths across components

DrawIO Diagram Editor

Self-hosted DrawIO with card-aware shapes and bidirectional sync to the repository

Time-Travel

View any report at a historical date — track how your architecture evolved over time

ServiceNow + OData + REST API

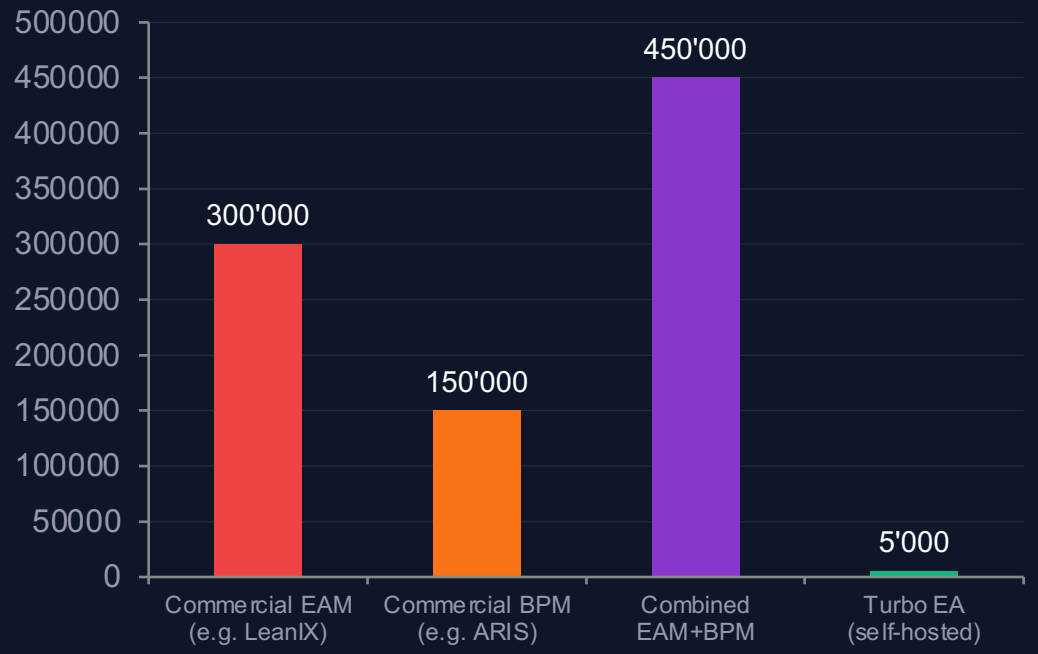
Bidirectional ServiceNow sync, OData feeds for Power BI/Excel, full REST API

Unlimited Users, Forever

No per-seat licensing, RBAC with 50+ granular permissions, SSO support

The Business Case

3-year total cost of ownership comparison



$0

License Cost (MIT Open Source)

~$1-2K/yr

Cloud VM + Internal Support

* Turbo EA is MIT-licensed and free. Estimate includes a small cloud VM (~$20/mo) and part-time internal support. Commercial estimates based on published mid-market pricing for 50-200 users.

Why Turbo EA

Advantages over commercial EAM/BPM platforms

Truly free — MIT open source

No license fees, no per-user pricing, no subscription tiers. Unlimited users forever. Only cost is your infrastructure.

Fast time-to-value

Pre-built metamodel with 13 card types and demo data. Excel bulk import gets you productive in days, not months.

EA + BPM + Diagrams in one tool

The only open-source platform with a native BPMN 2.0 editor. Eliminates separate BPM licenses (ARIS, Signavio).

Enterprise-grade features

RBAC (50+ permissions), ServiceNow integration, OData feeds, TOGAF SoAW, Time-Travel, endoflife.date tracking, web portals.

Full data sovereignty

Self-hosted — your architecture data never leaves your infrastructure. Air-gap compatible. Docker-native, deploys in under a minute.

Zero lock-in, zero risk

Excel/CSV export means you can migrate to any commercial tool at any time. MIT license lets you fork and extend freely.

What You Give Up

Honest trade-offs vs. established commercial platforms

No vendor support team

You own hosting, upgrades, and troubleshooting. Requires some internal IT capacity. No 24/7 helpdesk.

Integrations still maturing

ServiceNow and SSO are implemented but untested (v0.17.0). No pre-built Jira, Confluence, or CMDB connectors yet.

Less mature than market leaders

Actively evolving (v0.17.0). Advanced analytics, AI-driven insights, and some governance features may not yet match LeanIX or Ardoq.

No analyst validation

Not featured in Gartner or Forrester. If procurement requires analyst-endorsed vendors, this could block adoption.

Mitigation: Start with a 3-month pilot (app portfolio only). Validate fit before wider rollout. Excel export means you can always migrate to a commercial tool — zero sunk cost.

Head-to-Head Comparison

Capability	Commercial EAM (LeanIX / Ardoq)	Commercial BPM (ARIS / Signavio)	Turbo EA
App Portfolio Mgmt	✅ Advanced	❌ None	✅ Full
Capability Heatmap	✅ Advanced	⚠️ Limited	✅ Full
BPMN 2.0 Process Editor	⚠️ Basic	✅ Advanced	✅ Native
Dependency Analysis	✅ Advanced	❌ None	✅ Full
Diagram Editor	✅ Yes	✅ Yes	✅ DrawIO
Integrations (ServiceNow, OData)	✅ Extensive	✅ Moderate	⚠️ Growing
Vendor Support / SLA	✅ 24/7	✅ 24/7	❌ Community
Self-hosted / Air-gap	❌ SaaS only	⚠️ Some	✅ Docker native
Annual Cost (mid-size)	**$100K+**	**$50K+**	**$0 license**

Turbo EA

Recommendation

Start small. Prove value. Scale if it fits.

01	**3-Month Pilot**	Deploy via Docker. Import your app inventory from Excel. Assign 2-3 power users. The first user gets admin automatically.
02	**Validate & Compare**	Evaluate coverage against actual EA needs. Run commercial demos in parallel. Compare real experience, not just feature lists.
03	**Expand or Pivot**	If it fits, expand to BPM, capability mapping, and delivery tracking. If gaps are critical, export data to a commercial tool — zero sunk cost.